

Exercise 8G

Understanding

1–3

2(½), 3

- 1 State the missing values in this table.

x	0	1	2	3	4	5
2^x						
3^x						243
4^x					256	
5^x		5				
10^x			100			

Hint for Q1: recall that $a^0 = 1$ (except for $a = 0$)

- 2 State the value of the unknown number for each statement.

- a 2 to the power of what number gives 16?
 b 3 to the power of what number gives 81?
 c 7 to the power of what number gives 343?
 d 10 to the power of what number gives 10 000?

- 3 Give these numbers as fractions.

- a 0.0001 b 0.5 c 2^{-2} d 3^{-3}

Fluency

4–6(½), 8(½)

4–8(½)

Example 18 Writing equivalent statements involving logarithms

Write an equivalent statement to the following.

- a $\log_{10} 1000 = 3$ b $2^5 = 32$

Solution

a $10^3 = 1000$

Explanation

$\log_a y = x$ is equivalent to $a^x = y$.

b $\log_2 32 = 5$

$a^x = y$ is equivalent to $\log_a y = x$.

Now you try

Write an equivalent statement to the following.

- a $\log_{10} 100 = 2$ b $3^4 = 81$

- 4 Write the following in index form.

- a $\log_2 16 = 4$ b $\log_{10} 100 = 2$
 c $\log_3 27 = 3$ d $\log_2 \frac{1}{4} = -2$
 e $\log_{10} 0.1 = -1$ f $\log_3 \frac{1}{9} = -2$

Hint for Q4: If $\log_a y = x$ then $a^x = y$, $a > 0$, $y > 0$.

- 5 Write the following in logarithmic form.

- a $2^3 = 8$ b $3^4 = 81$
 c $2^5 = 32$ d $4^2 = 16$
 e $10^{-1} = \frac{1}{10}$ f $5^{-3} = \frac{1}{125}$

Hint for Q5: If $a^x = y$ then $\log_a y = x$, $a > 0$, $y > 0$.



Example 19 Evaluating logarithms

a Evaluate the following logarithms.

i $\log_2 8$

ii $\log_5 625$

b Evaluate the following.

i $\log_3 \frac{1}{9}$

ii $\log_{10} 0.001$

c Evaluate, correct to three decimal places, using a calculator.

i $\log_{10} 7$

ii $\log_{10} 0.5$

Solution

a i $\log_2 8 = 3$

ii $\log_5 625 = 4$

b i $\log_3 \frac{1}{9} = -2$

ii $\log_{10} 0.001 = -3$

c i $\log_{10} 7 = 0.845$ (to 3 d.p.)

ii $\log_{10} 0.5 = -0.301$ (to 3 d.p.)

Explanation

Ask the question '2 to what power gives 8?'

Note: $2^3 = 8$

$5^4 = 5 \times 5 \times 5 \times 5 = 625$

$3^{-2} = \frac{1}{3^2} = \frac{1}{9}$

$10^{-3} = \frac{1}{10^3} = \frac{1}{1000} = 0.001$

Use the log button on a calculator and use base 10. (Some calculators will give log base 10 by pressing the log button.)

Now you try

a Evaluate the following logarithms.

i $\log_2 16$

ii $\log_3 243$

b Evaluate the following.

i $\log_2 \frac{1}{8}$

ii $\log_{10} 0.01$

c Evaluate, correct to three decimal places, using a calculator.

i $\log_{10} 5$

ii $\log_{10} 0.45$

6 Evaluate the following logarithms.

a $\log_2 16$

b $\log_2 4$

c $\log_2 64$

d $\log_3 27$

e $\log_3 3$

f $\log_4 16$

g $\log_5 125$

h $\log_{10} 1000$

i $\log_7 49$

j $\log_{11} 121$

k $\log_{10} 100\,000$

l $\log_9 729$

m $\log_2 1$

n $\log_5 1$

o $\log_{37} 1$

p $\log_1 1$



Hint for Q6: For part **a**, 2 to what power gives 16?

7 Evaluate the following.

a $\log_2 \frac{1}{8}$

b $\log_2 \frac{1}{4}$

c $\log_3 \frac{1}{9}$

d $\log_{10} \frac{1}{1000}$

e $\log_7 \frac{1}{49}$

f $\log_3 \frac{1}{81}$

g $\log_5 \frac{1}{625}$

h $\log_8 \frac{1}{8}$

i $\log_{10} 0.1$

j $\log_{10} 0.001$

k $\log_{10} 0.00001$

l $\log_2 0.5$

m $\log_2 0.125$

n $\log_5 0.2$

o $\log_5 0.04$

p $\log_3 0.1$



Hint for Q7: Consider negative powers for fractions.

8G



8 Evaluate, correct to three decimal places, using a calculator.

a $\log_{10} 6$

b $\log_{10} 47$

c $\log_{10} 162$

d $\log_{10} 0.8$

e $\log_{10} 0.17$

f $\log_{10} \frac{1}{27}$

Problem-solving and reasoning

9,10

9–11

9 A single bacterium cell divides into two every minute.

a Complete this cell population table.

b Write a rule for the population, P , after t minutes.

c Use your rule to find the population after 8 minutes.

d Use trial and error to find the time (correct to the nearest minute) for the population to rise to 10 000.

e Write the exact answer to part d as a logarithm.

Time (minutes)	0	1	2	3	4	5
Population	1	2				

10 Consider a bacteria population growing such that the total increases 10-fold every hour.

a Complete this table for the population (P) and $\log_{10} P$ for 5 hours (h).

h	0	1	2	3	4	5
P	1	10	100			
$\log_{10} P$						

b Plot a graph of $\log_{10} P$ (y -axis) against hours (x -axis). What do you notice?

c Find a rule linking $\log_{10} P$ with h .

11 Is it possible for a logarithm (of the form $\log_a b$) to give a negative result? If so, give an example and reasons.



The Richter Magnitude

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12

12 The Richter magnitude of an earthquake is determined from a logarithm of the amplitude of waves recorded by a seismograph. It uses log base 10. So for example, an earthquake of magnitude 3 is 10 times more powerful than one with magnitude 2 and an earthquake of magnitude 7 is 100 times more powerful than one with magnitude 5.

a Write the missing number. An earthquake of magnitude 6 is:

i times more powerful than one of magnitude 5.

ii times more powerful than one of magnitude 4.

iii times more powerful than one of magnitude 2.

b Write the missing number. An earthquake of magnitude 9 is:

i times more powerful than one of magnitude 8.

ii 1000 times more powerful than one of magnitude .

iii 10^6 times more powerful than one of magnitude .